

SONNY STEELE

Principal UX Designer | AI/ML Product Designer & Engineer | Director of UX

413.570.6737 | sonny@sonny-steele.com | Olympia, WA | [Portfolio](#) | linkedin.com/in/sonnysteele

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

20+ years designing enterprise AI/ML products; the last few years building them end-to-end as a designer-engineer. Recently solo-built ScoutAI on Next.js, TypeScript, the Claude API, Prisma/Postgres, a Playwright worker, and a Chrome Extension. Track record of \$60M+ revenue impact, 35% platform adoption gains, and 92% system failure prevention across AI, fintech, healthcare, and e-commerce. Comfortable owning the full stack: design system, frontend code, API integration, and product strategy.

IMPACT AT A GLANCE

- \$60M+ combined revenue impact and cost savings across AI, fintech, e-commerce, and enterprise platforms
- 50M+ monthly users served across AI/ML products — conversational AI for Fortune 500 financial institutions
- 35% platform adoption increase (Kasisto) · 5% conversion lift = \$6M revenue (FCP Euro) · 40% decision speed gain (HealthCare.com)
- 92% system failure prevention rate through anomaly detection UI design at Ottermon AI
- FDA 510(k)-compliant medical device interfaces and HIPAA-compliant enterprise healthcare platforms
- Solo-shipped ScoutAI end-to-end on Next.js, TypeScript, Claude API, Prisma, Playwright, and Chrome Extension MV3 — also built UX functions from zero at multiple orgs and led 20+ cross-functional teams

CORE COMPETENCIES

Agentic & Conversational AI UX: Agentic experience systems, multi-modal interfaces, conversational AI, ML training UIs, anomaly detection, AI-powered analytics, prompt/response UX

Systems & Interaction Design: Systems-level thinking, end-to-end experience design, journey-centric design, information architecture, interaction design, design systems strategy

Leadership & Strategy: 0-to-1 product design, product strategy, cross-functional influence, design org strategy, roadmap ownership, OKR alignment, DesignOps, stakeholder management, Agile/Scrum

Design Execution: Figma (advanced: tokens, variants, auto-layout, prototyping), design systems, wireframing, accessibility, WCAG/ADA

Research & Validation: User research, usability testing (UserTesting, Maze), design thinking, large dataset visualization, analytics dashboard design

Regulatory: HIPAA, FDA 510(k) UX compliance, WCAG/ADA enterprise standards, financial services regulatory UX

AI/ML Engineering & Tools: Claude API + prompt engineering, Next.js + TypeScript, Prisma/Postgres, Playwright, Chrome Extension (MV3), Cursor, Claude, ChatGPT/GPT-4, Midjourney, Adobe Firefly, Notion AI

SKILLS

- AI-Assisted Development: Claude Code, Cursor, Claude API — pair-coding, agentic workflows, prompt engineering & evaluation
- Full-Stack Implementation: Next.js + TypeScript, Prisma/Postgres, Chrome Extension (MV3), Playwright browser automation
- Design-to-Code: Figma → React component implementation, design tokens in production code, shipped UI
- Advanced Figma: Component Libraries, Auto-Layout, Variants, Design Tokens, Prototyping & Interactive User Flows
- Agentic & Multi-Modal Experience Design — Conversational UI, Orchestration Flows, Personalization Systems
- Journey-Centric Design Systems — GTM, Post-Purchase, Customer Success Experiences
- Design Systems Strategy, Implementation & Governance
- End-to-End Design, Design Critiques & Design QA
- Developer Handoff, Design Specs & Cross-Functional Collaboration (Engineering, Product, Data Science)
- Interaction Design & Information Architecture
- Mobile Design & Responsive/Adaptive Interfaces
- Accessibility Auditing & Inclusive Design (WCAG 2.1 AA)
- Data Visualization & Dashboard Design for Large-Scale Datasets
- User Research, Usability Testing & Design Thinking Facilitation
- Agile/Scrum Workflows, Sprint Planning & JIRA

- Product Strategy, Roadmap Development & OKR Alignment

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Self-Employed — UX Design Director & Principal AI/ML Consultant Jan 2024 – Present

Director-level UX engagements for enterprise AI companies. Defined UX strategy, owned design roadmaps, and drove OKR-aligned outcomes across client organizations. Concurrently founded ScoutAI (AI-powered job search platform) and led product design for Spectra (smart-home installer SaaS).

ScoutAI — Founder & Lead Designer-Engineer Jan 2026 – Present

AI-powered job search agent that scrapes 51 job boards daily, detects ghost listings via a 16-signal Reality Score, and auto-applies with AI-generated cover letters tailored to each user's voice.

- Built and shipped solo end-to-end: Next.js 15 + TypeScript + Claude Sonnet API, Prisma/Postgres on Neon, Railway-hosted Playwright worker, and Chrome Extension (Manifest V3) — covering resume parsing, job matching, ghost detection, and auto-application
- Designed and built the Reality Score — a 16-point check that scores each job on ATS link health, posting age, salary clarity, and 13 other signals to filter out fake listings before they hit the user feed
- Built a system on the Claude API that learns each person's writing style — their go-to verbs and the kinds of numbers they use to show impact — and writes new cover letters that sound like them
- Built the system that connects ScoutAI to 51 job sites including Greenhouse, Workday, and Lever; designed and shipped the components, apply flows, and auto-apply engine end-to-end

Spectra — Lead Designer-Engineer Feb 2026 – Apr 2026

AI-powered platform for smart-home and low-voltage AV installers. Users upload a floor plan, AI generates the device layout, and it flows into wiring diagrams, proposals, and install schedules — one source of truth.

- Led product design across the full surface — sign-in, dashboard, project hub, equipment specs, floor plans, and schedule/payments — for both iPad and desktop
- Built the brand and design system from zero — colors, typography, components, and tokens — giving a polished SaaS surface to a category still run on clipboards and spreadsheets
- Designed the AI floor-plan workflow — users upload a plan, AI generates the device layout and component placements, and the result feeds straight into the wiring diagram and proposal pipeline
- Designed every key flow end-to-end, then fed final specs into Claude for the engineering team — cutting build time and rework during the first development cycle

Humanyze — Principal AI Designer-Engineer Aug 2025 – Jan 2026

Enterprise social media competitive intelligence platform serving marketing directors and C-suite at Fortune 500 brands.

- Redesigned core analytics interface and data visualization strategy, transforming millions of social data points into executive-ready competitive insights
- Created sentiment analysis dashboards that reduced executive decision-making time by streamlining competitive analysis workflows; findings presented directly to C-suite
- Built and shipped the React-ready component library and design tokens — partnered with engineering to land patterns directly in production code

Kasisto — Head of UX Design & Engineering Jan 2025 – Jul 2025

Enterprise conversational AI platform powering digital assistants for Fortune 500 financial institutions handling 50M+ monthly customer interactions across 4 product lines.

- Drove 35% platform adoption increase by owning end-to-end UX roadmap across 4 product lines — including stakeholder alignment, design strategy, and cross-functional execution
- Reduced ML model setup time from 3 weeks to 2 days by redesigning training interfaces to empower non-technical banking professionals; presented ROI case to executive leadership
- Built real-time analytics dashboards across 200+ banking use cases — defined data contracts, ML pipeline inputs, and edge cases alongside the engineering team
- Defined UX team processes and mentored junior designers in AI/ML UX principles, increasing team velocity and output quality

Ottermon AI — Lead UX Designer, AI Monitoring Jan 2024 – Jan 2025

Enterprise AI monitoring platform for infrastructure and DevOps teams. Designed UX for anomaly detection and predictive failure systems across 15+ infrastructure modules.

- Designed anomaly detection UI that prevented 92% of system failures pre-impact, delivering measurable uptime improvements for enterprise clients
- Built analytics dashboards that reduced mean time to resolution (MTTR) by 50% through actionable data visualization

- Owned design system strategy supporting 15+ infrastructure modules, establishing unified UX patterns and scalable component governance
- Designed and prototyped model training interfaces alongside ML engineers — defining parameter tuning, threshold visualization, and feedback loops for custom anomaly detection algorithms

HealthCare.com — Senior UX Manager 2022 – 2024

AI-powered healthcare platform matching users with health and supplemental insurance using ML-driven personalization and real-time health scoring.

- Improved decision speed by 40% and lowered user costs by 25% by leading design of an AI-driven healthcare recommendation platform
- Designed ML-powered health scoring with the data science team — defined model inputs, feature weighting, and threshold tuning that drove the recommendation engine
- Increased user engagement with preventive care by 35% through predictive health scoring interfaces identifying risks and recommending interventions
- Designed HIPAA-compliant UX across cost tracking, benefit optimization, and AI health scoring — enabling enterprise adoption while maintaining regulatory integrity

FCP Euro — Senior UX Director 2020 – 2022

Premier e-commerce platform serving European car enthusiasts with 350,000+ genuine and performance parts. Built the UX function from the ground up.

- Generated \$6M in additional annual revenue through a 5% conversion rate increase achieved in 3 months — result of a ground-up redesign of the parts-finding experience
- Reduced support call volume by 45% through strategic UI improvements informed by call center analytics
- Built and scaled the UX team from zero, establishing data-driven design processes, tooling, and standards across the organization

Wayfair — Senior UX Design Manager 2018 – 2020

Led UX strategy for CastleGate, Wayfair's \$2B+ logistics platform managing ocean freight, drayage, and last-mile delivery for furniture and home goods.

- Saved \$16M in operational costs by leading system design that reduced supplier time-on-task by 8 hours daily across thousands of active suppliers
- Reduced customer success manager time-on-task by 18 hours weekly through information architecture optimization
- Managed 5 cross-functional work stream pods — each comprising 3 designers, 1 content writer, and 1 PM; mentored 2 employees off performance improvement plans

Hexaware Technologies — Principal UX Designer 2011 – 2018

UX design lead for Fortune 500 enterprise clients across healthcare, retail, fitness, and media.

- Increased Panera Bread mobile orders by 40% by designing a menu navigation and customization experience optimized for mobile-first ordering
- Designed UPMC healthcare platform improving patient care workflows and medical data integration for clinical staff
- Created Weight Watchers wellness platform supporting millions of users with personalized nutrition tracking and community engagement
- Built platforms for Wawa, Comcast Tech Nucleus, Reebok ONE, and Weather Channel — spanning retail POS, enterprise tech, fitness wearables, and media

TOOLS & PLATFORMS

Figma (advanced) • Next.js + TypeScript • Prisma/Postgres • Claude API • Playwright • Chrome Extension MV3 • Cursor • UserTesting • Maze • JIRA • Adobe Creative Suite • Claude • ChatGPT/GPT-4 • Midjourney • Adobe Firefly • Notion AI